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CS-499: Computer Science Capstone

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Narratives

1. Briefly describe the artifact. What is it? When was it created?

The selected artifact for this enhancement was an Android event planner application, which I originally created in CS 360: Mobile Architecture and Programming about a year ago. The application included features such as logging in, registering, creating events, and viewing events through multiple screens like the calendar view, today view, settings page, and event cards. This application originally worked and met the standards for that class; however, many aspects of the design and navigation were pretty outdated, unprofessional, and basic.

2. Justify the inclusion of the artifact in your ePortfolio. Why did you select this item?

What specific components of the artifact showcase your skills and abilities in software development? How was the artifact improved?

As previously mentioned in the module one template, this artifact was one of the few projects from the approved course list that I still had fully available and functional.

Furthermore, it was something tangible that could realistically be improved and tweaked to meet most, if not all, course outcomes. Additionally, this specific project had the most potential because it could be tweaked for all three enhancement categories and become closer to a full-stack application. This specific enhancement was mainly focused on redesigning the UI, improving navigation, organizing the menu, reducing clutter and redundant features, and making things cleaner and more concise. In essence, I improved multiple XML layout files, including the main, calendar, settings, and event card views.

3. Did you meet the course outcomes you planned to meet with this enhancement in Module One? Do you have any updates to your outcome-coverage plans?

I do think that I've met the course outcomes that I originally planned for in the module one template. This project was a great way to highlight some improvements and demonstrate a more professional-looking interface. It specifically aligns with the outcome focused on delivering professional, technically sound, and visually organized solutions for specific audiences. Nevertheless, although some outcomes were met, I still would like to continue tweaking and improving this artifact. There are still some parts that need some polishing that will be addressed before the final submission.

4. Reflect on the process of enhancing and modifying the artifact. What did you learn as you were creating it and improving it? What challenges did you face?

There were not that many challenges during the enhancement process; in fact, the biggest issue was simply understanding the XML layout files and experimenting with colors,

spacing, and ideas. As for the programming logic, it was not difficult, but creating a cleaner interface did require a lot of trial and error. One thing I learned from this process was how important usability and visual organization are in software design. Some additional work was done to add a stub calendar into the project. That said, most of that implementation came from online videos and ideas reused from an older mobile app I had previously created to track pets. Nevertheless, there was a lot to reinforce and go over, which made this first milestone extremely rewarding.